

Daily Economic Briefing

Tuesday, 22 September 2026 | Window: Sun 20 Sept 20:00 ET – Mon 21 Sept 23:29 ET (session: Monday 21 Sept close/AH) | Research cutoff 21 Sept 2026, 23:29 ET | Edition 25

Assumptions, corrections and status this edition

- Fed Chair Kevin Warsh re-confirmed fresh against federalreserve.gov's own Board of Governors page (22 Sept fetch) — unchanged, per standing instruction to re-verify every edition.^[16]
- The Bank of Japan's next policy meeting — the top open item carried from the previous edition — is now confirmed as October 29–30, 2026, direct from boj.or.jp's own schedule page.^[21]
- Friday 18 Sept's 2-year Treasury yield, which went entirely unobtained last edition, is now resolved via the Treasury's own official H.15 par-yield table: 4.44%.^[27]
- EUR/USD and GBP/USD, a structural sourcing gap for three straight editions, produced clean single closes this run via Yahoo Finance — flagged as single-sourced and not yet cross-corroborated by a second independent vendor.^[37]
- Kalshi's October-hike odds remain rate-limited on direct fetch for a third straight edition; the figure used is again search-cached with an imprecise timestamp.^[19]
- Monday's WTI settlement is disclosed as a range (\$92.28–\$95.80/bbl): sources disagree by more than 3%, and the higher end is used as the better-reconciled figure against Friday's confirmed base.^{[29][31]}
- The Trump-Xi Washington summit, "tentative" as of the previous edition, is now reported as proceeding Thursday 24 Sept.^[23]
- Whether Monday's quarterly index rebalance produced above-normal trading volume could not be confirmed either way this edition — see Annex A.

60-second read

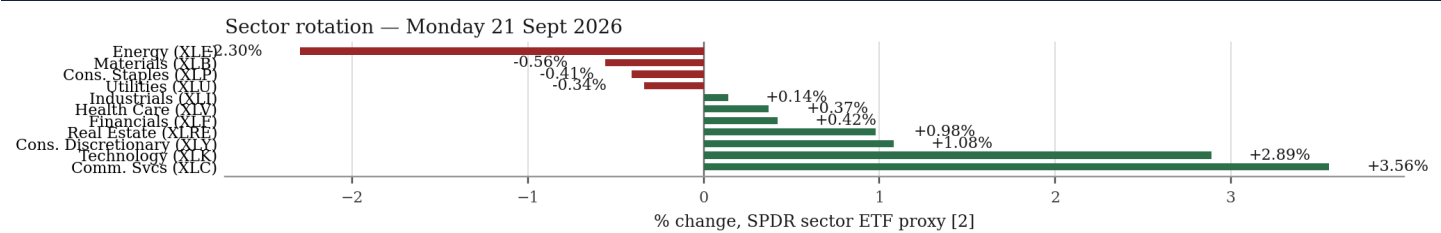
- A broad chip-stock rally (Intel, AMD, Qualcomm and Arm Holdings all up high-single to double digits) pushed the Nasdaq Composite to a record close of 27,122.09 (+2.26%), with the S&P 500 (+1.49%) and Dow (+0.71%) also higher, as a pullback in the 10-year yield (to approx. 4.96%) and a sharp drop in oil offset an otherwise still-hawkish rate backdrop.^[1]
- The quarterly S&P 500/400/600 and Nasdaq-100 rebalance took effect at Monday's open — Bloom Energy, Illumina and Everpure joined the S&P 500 in place of Molson Coors, The Trade Desk and Builders FirstSource, and SpaceX's Nasdaq-100 weight jumped to 2.82% from 1.28% — but whether it drove above-normal trading volume on the day itself could not be confirmed.^{[9][10]}
- October-hike odds held in a mid-to-high-50s band across venues (Polymarket approx. 53% hike, Kalshi approx. 55-56%, CME FedWatch secondary citations approx. 56-60%) — still the modal outcome heading into the Oct 27-28 FOMC, but with no single clean number across sources.^{[18][19][20]}
- The Bank of Japan's next policy meeting is now confirmed for Oct 29-30, 2026, resolving the top open item carried from the previous edition.^[21]
- Oil fell hard — Brent approx. -3.0% to \$100.34, WTI approx. -4.5% into the \$95.50-95.80 range — on reported Iran-Oman diplomacy around reopening Strait of Hormuz shipping, even as the Houthis continue to threaten Saudi-flagged targets specifically.^{[29][30][32][33]}

1. Market recap

S&P 500 7,764.70 +1.49%	Dow Jones 52,048.83 +0.71%	Nasdaq Comp. 27,122.09 +2.26% (record)	Russell 2000 2,875.36 +0.52%	10-yr yield approx. 4.96% from 5.01% Fri	VIX 14.87 +0.41%
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Monday was a clean risk-on session led entirely by semiconductors: Intel, AMD, Qualcomm and Arm Holdings all rallied on renewed AI/chip-demand enthusiasm, lifting the Nasdaq to its best close on record and pulling the S&P and Dow along with it, even as a handful of index-provider mechanics — the quarterly S&P/Nasdaq-100 rebalance taking effect at the open, following Friday's triple-witching expiration — added extra churn under the surface.^[1] The 10-year Treasury yield eased back from Friday's 5.01% print to approx. 4.96% and oil sold off sharply, both helping risk sentiment even as October-hike odds stayed elevated across prediction markets.^[27]

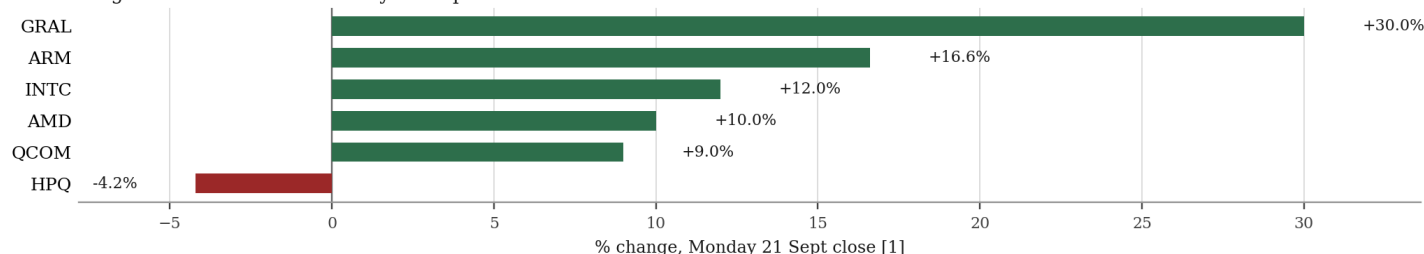
2. Equities and earnings



Technology (XLK +2.89%) and Communication Services (XLC +3.56%) led a broad-based rally, Consumer Discretionary (XLY +1.08%) and Real Estate (XLRE +0.98%) also outperformed, while Energy (XLE -2.30%) was the clear laggard on the day's oil selloff and Materials (XLB -0.56%) and Utilities (XLU -0.34%) also finished lower.^[2]

Single-stock movers

Single-stock movers — Monday 21 Sept 2026



Ticker	Move	Driver
GRAL	approx. +30%	FDA scheduled an advisory-committee review of Grail's Galleri multi-cancer blood test ^[7]
ARM	+16.6% to \$322.90	Piper Sandler initiated Overweight, \$320 PT, amid broad chip-demand optimism ^[5]
INTC	+12.0%	Broad CPU/chip-stock rally on renewed AI-driven demand optimism ^[3]
AMD	approx. +10%	Closed above \$1 trillion market cap for the first time, part of the same chip rally ^[4]
QCOM	approx. +9%	Carried by the same semiconductor-sector rally ^[6]
HPQ	-4.22%	Withheld FY2027 guidance, warned PC unit volumes to decline mid-single-digits through 2027 (best-sourced figure; other aggregators ranged -2% to -10.5%, unreconciled) ^[8]

The earnings docket was thin between Friday's close and Monday's close — only minor names (Legacy Housing, Aytu BioPharma, Ennis) reported, all before the open Monday, with no market-moving reaction.^[12] Analyst actions were more active: BMO Capital raised HubSpot's PT to \$250 (Market Perform maintained); Morgan Stanley raised Palo Alto Networks to \$410 and CrowdStrike to \$254 (both Overweight maintained); KeyBanc raised Darden Restaurants to \$245 (Overweight); BofA Securities downgraded Equifax to Neutral, PT cut to \$285; UBS cut Callaway Golf's PT to \$17 (Neutral).^[13] Separately, Friday 18 Sept's analyst-roundup names are now confirmed in full: JPMorgan upgraded Tyson Foods to Overweight (PT cut to \$63), Ball Corp. and Crown Holdings both to Overweight; UBS upgraded Waste Connections to Buy (PT \$200); Redburn upgraded Southwest Airlines to Neutral (PT \$40); BofA upgraded Equinor to Buy (PT \$49); Accenture drew a split call — Deutsche Bank raised its PT to \$175 while maintaining Hold, but Guggenheim downgraded to Neutral on channel checks showing no demand improvement, and the stock fell approx. 4% that day.^{[14][15]}

The quarterly rebalance itself is fully confirmed: Bloom Energy, Illumina and Everpure joined the S&P 500 effective Monday's open, replacing Molson Coors, The Trade Desk and Builders FirstSource; SpaceX's Nasdaq-100 weight rose to 2.82% from 1.28%.^{[9][10]} The bulk of the reshuffle's trading executed in Friday's closing auction (an estimated approx. \$294bn imbalance, with NYSE volume approx. 155% above its one-month average that day), but no source could confirm or rule out whether Monday's session itself, with the new weights already in effect, saw above-normal volume or volatility as a result.^[11]

3. Macro, policy and rates

Fed Chair Kevin Warsh and the Committee's Oct 27-28 next meeting date are both re-confirmed unchanged direct from federalreserve.gov.^{[16][17]} October-hike odds: Polymarket approx. 53% hike/47% hold (direct fetch, \$9.17m volume); Kalshi approx. 55-56% hike (still rate-limited on direct fetch, search-cached); secondary CME FedWatch citations disagree, approx. 56% versus approx. 59.7% (the official page remains blocked to direct fetch). Taken together, the range across venues is roughly 53-60% probability of an October hike, still the modal outcome but not a single number.^{[18][19][20]} No US economic data releases fell on Monday 21 Sept itself.^[22] The Trump-Xi Washington summit, previously reported as tentative, is now described as proceeding Thursday 24 Sept, covering trade-truce extension, AI, rare earths and Taiwan ahead of the 90-day tariff truce's expiration; separately, the US import ban on Canadian dairy, alcoholic beverages and motor vehicles remains on track to take effect 29 Sept.^{[23][24]} Thursday 24 Sept also brings four other central-bank decisions: Norges Bank and Banxico are both confirmed for that date; Riksbank is likely 24 Sept but not fully primary-confirmed; the SNB's exact date could not be pinned to either 24 or 25 Sept this run (see Annex A).^{[25][26]} On rates, the 10-year eased to approx. 4.96% Monday from Friday's 5.01%, while the 2-year was little-changed at approx. 4.45% versus Friday's now-resolved 4.44% official print.^[27] SOFR held at Thursday's elevated 3.85% through Friday; Monday's reading is not yet published (normal one-day lag) and the cause of the mid-week jump from 3.62% remains unexplained.^[28]

4. Commodities and FX

Instrument	Level	Chg	Note
Brent	\$100.34	-2.97%	Iran-Oman diplomacy on reopening Hormuz shipping eases risk premium ^{[29][30]}
WTI	approx. \$95.50-95.80	approx. -4.5%	sources diverge \$92.28-\$95.80; higher end better reconciles with Friday's base ^{[30][31]}
Gold	\$4,378.63	approx. -0.1%	roughly flat; Yahoo GC=F variant \$4,383.90 near-identical ^{[34][35]}
Silver	\$65.82	-0.47%	reconciles cleanly against Friday's \$66.13 ^[34]
Copper (LME cash)	\$14,788/t	+1.78%	Westmetall.com fallback; SMM (metal.com) failed a 4th straight edition ^[36]
DXY	100.43	+0.21%	first clean single close in several editions ^[37]
EUR/USD	1.1480	approx. +0.03%	single-sourced (Yahoo), first clean read in 3 editions ^[37]
GBP/USD	1.3389	approx. +0.23%	single-sourced (Yahoo), first clean read in 3 editions ^[37]
USD/JPY	157.05	+0.59%	yen weakness continues; range tightened vs. Friday's 155.7-158.1 ^{[37][38]}

Oil's drop was driven by reported Iran-Oman diplomacy toward reopening Strait of Hormuz shipping lanes around the UN General Assembly, which markets read as reducing the supply-risk premium built up over recent weeks.^[32] Separately, the Houthis publicly pledged not to target US-flagged vessels while explicitly continuing to threaten Saudi-linked targets; no Monday-dated update was found on Saudi Aramco's Yanbu pipeline-restoration progress, which has been offline since a 10 Sept drone strike.^[33] Gold and silver held broadly flat, with the dollar firming modestly across DXY, EUR/USD and GBP/USD.^{[34][37]}

Commodities & FX levels: Friday 18 Sept baseline vs. Monday 21 Sept

Instrument	Fri 18 Sept close	Mon 21 Sept close	% chg
Brent	\$103.87	\$100.34	-2.97%
WTI	\$100.30	approx. \$95.50-95.80	approx. -4.5%
Gold	\$4,382.38	\$4,378.63	approx. -0.1%
Silver	\$66.13	\$65.82	-0.47%
Copper (LME cash)	\$14,529/t	\$14,788/t	+1.78%
DXY	approx. 100.2-100.5 (no clean close)	100.43	+0.21%
EUR/USD	1.1476	1.1480	approx. +0.03%
GBP/USD	1.3358	1.3389	approx. +0.23%
USD/JPY	156.13	157.05	+0.59%

5. Derivatives, volatility and positioning

VIX closed 14.87, +0.41% versus Friday's logged 14.81, computed manually after the Cboe feed's `prev_day_close` bug duplicated the day's own close for a fourth straight edition.^{[39][40]} Term structure stayed in normal contango (VIX9D 13.14, VIX 14.87, VIX3M 18.08, VIX6M 20.16); the front-end's post-16-Sept-FOMC unwind looks to have largely stabilized, with VIX9D no longer swinging by double-digit percentages day-to-day as the event ages further out of its 9-day lookback window.^[39] VVIX read 85.77 and SKEW 142.19.^[39] VIX options volume was approx. 713,342 contracts (449,179 calls/264,163 puts) per Cboe's daily statistics page, though that figure carries only moderate confidence since the page did not carry an explicit date stamp.^[41] CFTC CoT data remains dated 15 Sept (published Friday 18 Sept) with no new report in this window; the next update is due approx. 25 Sept.^[42] Dealer gamma is unavailable this edition: SpotGamma's own site returned no live figures, and third-party GEX dollar estimates found in search did not reconcile with any plausible SPX exposure and were discarded. SOFR held at Thursday's 3.85% through Friday, Monday's print not yet posted, cause of the mid-week jump still unexplained (see Section 3).^[28]

6. The day ahead

Date	Event	Consensus / context
Tue 23 Sept	Richmond Fed Manufacturing Index	No consensus figure sourced this edition
Thu 24 Sept	US Current Account (Q2); New Home Sales (Aug); Norges Bank, Banxico, Riksbank (likely) and SNB (date unresolved) rate decisions	Four central banks decide same day — watch for a broader hawkish/dovish read-through beyond the Fed
Fri 25 Sept	Durable Goods Orders (Aug, prelim); U. Michigan Consumer Sentiment (Sept, final)	Prior UMich final print (47.8) was the second-weakest on record
Tue 29 – Wed 30 Sept (following week, context)	Consumer Confidence (Tue); Chicago PMI (Wed)	Flagged for context only, outside this edition's window

Sector setup we take into Tuesday's session

- Technology/semis: Monday's chip-rally momentum carries into Meta's Connect developer conference (23-24 Sept), a fresh catalyst for the same names.
- Watch whether October-hike odds converge further or diverge again as Thursday's four other central-bank decisions land alongside the ongoing Fed repricing.
- Oil: further Hormuz-diplomacy headlines could extend Monday's selloff, but Houthi threats specifically against Saudi targets remain a live tail risk.
- Rebalance follow-through: watch the next few sessions for any delayed volume/volatility effect from Monday's quarterly index reshuffle now that it has had a full day to settle.
- Enterprise software/IT services: Accenture's split analyst call (PT raised, but a demand-channel-check downgrade) is worth watching for read-across to other IT-services names reporting into October.
- Autos: last week's dealer-sector weakness (AutoNation guidance, Sonic Automotive) remains a backdrop for Tuesday, though no fresh dealer-specific catalyst is scheduled.

Annex A — Data points sought but not verified this edition

- SNB's exact September 2026 decision date (24th vs. 25th) — conflicting sourcing, one hit reads as a possibly mis-surfaced 2025 article.
- Dealer gamma for Monday 21 Sept — SpotGamma inaccessible; third-party GEX dollar figures found did not reconcile with a plausible SPX exposure and were discarded.
- Monday 21 Sept's SOFR reading — not yet published by the NY Fed or FRED at cutoff (normal lag); the cause of the 17 Sept jump from 3.62% to 3.85% remains unexplained.
- Whether Monday's quarterly index rebalance produced above-normal trading volume or volatility — no source confirmed or denied this.
- Official CME FedWatch October-hike probability — page still blocks direct fetch; two secondary citations disagree (approx. 56% vs. approx. 59.7%).
- Riksbank's exact 24 Sept decision date — plausible via a Riksbank press-release title surfaced in search, not confirmed via a direct riksbank.se fetch.
- Asbury Automotive's exact Thursday 17 Sept close/move — conflicting figures (-3.73% vs. approx. -4.8% to -5.0%) across three research passes now; dropping this thread going forward.
- Seagate's and SK Hynix's exact Friday 18 Sept moves — multiple non-reconciled figures found across sources; dropping this thread going forward.
- Confirmation, via a primary index-provider source, of reported plans for Block Inc. to replace Hess Corp. in the S&P 500 — found only in secondary market-wrap coverage this edition.

Annex B — Sources

- [1] AP, "How major US stock indexes fared Monday," via WTOP, 21 Sept 2026; corroborated by wusa9.com/Washington Post syndication and independently by CNBC/TheStreet market-wrap figures
- [2] Stockanalysis.com, SPDR sector ETF price-history pages (XLK, XLC, XLY, XLV, XLRE, XLF, XLI, XLU, XLP, XLB, XLE), 21 Sept 2026
- [3] CNBC, "Intel surges 12% as CPU stocks rally, here's what's driving the move," 21 Sept 2026
- [4] Bloomberg, "AMD set to top \$1 trillion in market value as chip stocks soar," 21 Sept 2026
- [5] StocksToTrade, Arm Holdings (ARM) news coverage, 21 Sept 2026, incl. Piper Sandler Overweight initiation
- [6] Yahoo Finance market coverage, Qualcomm (QCOM), 21 Sept 2026
- [7] Investrade, "Market Review — September 21, 2026"
- [8] Stockanalysis.com, HP Inc. (HPQ) price-history table, 21 Sept 2026; TipRanks, TradingPedia and Investing.com coverage of the FY2027 guidance withdrawal
- [9] S&P Global press release, 4 Sept 2026 (quarterly index changes), corroborated by StockTitan and Bloomberg
- [10] Bloomberg, "SpaceX's Nasdaq 100 Weight Is Confirmed at 2.82%," 19 Sept 2026
- [11] QSG Research (qsgcap.substack.com), September 2026 quarterly-rebalance trade estimates
- [12] Newsquawk, "Weekly US Earnings Estimates: 21st-25th September 2026"
- [13] Benzinga/DailyTradeAlert, "Analyst Upgrades and Downgrades for Monday, 9/21," 21 Sept 2026
- [14] GuruFocus, Investing.com, MarketBeat and MarketScreener analyst-action coverage, dated 18 Sept 2026
- [15] Invezz.com, Accenture analyst-split coverage, 18 Sept 2026
- [16] federalreserve.gov, Board of Governors membership page, fetched 22 Sept 2026
- [17] federalreserve.gov, FOMC meeting calendar, fetched 22 Sept 2026
- [18] Polymarket, "Fed decision in October" event page, direct fetch 22 Sept 2026
- [19] Kalshi, Fed-decision market (search-cached; direct fetch rate-limited)
- [20] Secondary CME FedWatch citations (two, disagreeing), dated approx. 20 Sept 2026
- [21] boj.or.jp, Monetary Policy Meeting schedule, fetched 22 Sept 2026
- [22] BLS, September 2026 economic release schedule
- [23] CNBC, US News and Eastern Herald coverage of the Trump-Xi Washington summit, 21 Sept 2026
- [24] CNBC, coverage of the US import ban on Canadian goods, 9 Sept 2026
- [25] Norges Bank and Banco de México (Banxico) policy-decision calendars
- [26] Riksbank press release title, "The September monetary policy meeting will be held in Gothenburg" (search-derived)
- [27] US Treasury, Daily Treasury Par Yield Curve Rates, September 2026, home.treasury.gov (direct fetch)
- [28] New York Fed SOFR data and FRED series SOFR (both capped at 18 Sept 2026 as of this fetch)
- [29] Investing.com, Brent crude historical data
- [30] WorldOil.com, "Brent falls to \$100 as Strait of Hormuz oil flows increase," 21 Sept 2026
- [31] TradingEconomics, crude oil commodity page
- [32] CBS News, live updates, Iran/Strait of Hormuz, 21 Sept 2026
- [33] Euronews, "Yemen's Houthis pledge not to target US ships after Trump cancels strikes," 21 Sept 2026
- [34] Yahoo Finance historical data, GC=F/SI=F futures
- [35] Bloomberg, XAU spot gold quote
- [36] Westmetall.com, LME copper cash-settlement table
- [37] Yahoo Finance historical data, DX-Y.NYB / EURUSD=X / GBPUSD=X / JPY=X
- [38] Orbex, USD/JPY market commentary, 21 Sept 2026
- [39] Cboe, cdn.cboe.com delayed-quotes JSON (VIX, VIX9D, VIX3M, VIX6M, VVIX, SKEW)
- [40] Yahoo Finance, VIX historical data (corroboration)
- [41] Cboe, US Options Daily Market Statistics page
- [42] cftc.gov, Traders in Financial Futures (financial_if.htm) and legacy CFE (deacboelf.htm) reports

Method: every figure traces to a named source in Annex B; where sources disagreed, the better-corroborated figure was used and the conflict disclosed. Nothing estimated or filled from memory — unverifiable items are listed in Annex A. Not investment advice.